great that it seemed more prudent not to employ men whose religion (however well inclined to us the men may be) *might* be employed as a means to seduce them from their duty'.

Elaborate measures were taken to make sure that Dost Mohammad did not escape or enter into correspondence with the Afghan rebels. 'The Ameer's premises are guarded day and night by sentries,' wrote Nicholson, 'and the roads leading to it from Landour, as also from Rajpoor, are constantly watched by sentries. None of the Ameer's followers will be allowed to pass out beyond the sentries, no strangers whatsoever admitted within them, except by my pass, which will only be granted when necessary, and the individuals going out will be accompanied by a European guard.' Further precautions were taken to prevent correspondence:

> . . . I am establishing a small thannah [police post] at the foot of the hills which will watch the advent of all strangers from the Westward, especially Afghans or Kashmiris, and give me instant notice of the arrival of any suspicious characters . . . At the head of this I propose placing an individual of my present establishment who speaks all the languages of the trans-Indus countries, and with him will be associated a Hindu chupprussie and four hillmen. Their orders are to accompany secretly any suspected individual up the hill, till he reaches the nearest sentry, and then to hand him over to the guard, which is to be posted close to the Ameer's house.

As an additional measure, Nicholson recommended that all Kashmiris be banned from the Mussoorie hills, unless they had a special pass,

> [because] an Afghan messenger would not be likely personally to attempt communicating with the prisoner so closely watched as Dost Mohammad Khan, but would have recourse to one less liable to suspicion; in all probability to a Kashmiri.
>
> Their character as Cossids [messengers] is too well known to need mention and of them I am especially apprehensive. Hence I would suggest that orders be given at Ludhiana and Amballah, that no Kashmiri should be permitted to visit the Dhoon [Valley] or the hills without a pass from yourself. It would probably too aid my efforts if a note of any Kashmiri traveller were to be sent to me by dak by the police officers of the Amballah district, and this would be a check on my own thanna people.

Clerk approved of all Nicholson's measures and in addition gave Nicholson special authority to 'arrest and most closely search any suspicious individual'.[9]

In the meantime, everyone turned their fire on Auckland. In Jalalabad, the night Brydon rode in, Thomas Seaton had written in his diary: 'That Elphinstone's imbecility was the immediate cause of this disgrace and of